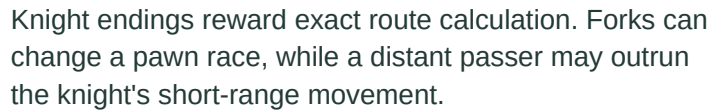


## Knight-ending routes

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: knight on f3. Check for tactical protection.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**47.Kxf3** The king captures the knight on f3. Recorded reply: **47...Kg1**.

**48.Kxf4** The king captures the pawn on f4. Recorded reply: **48...h2**.

**49.Ng3** The knight moves from f5 to g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.